

Northstar Analytics — Employee Operations & Security Policy

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1. Company Overview

Northstar Analytics is a fictional software company that provides data analytics and business intelligence tools for mid-sized organizations.

The company was founded in **2019** and is headquartered in **Bengaluru, India**.

Northstar Analytics has approximately **180 employees** working across engineering, product, sales, customer success, and operations.

2. Remote Work Policy

Eligible employees may work remotely for up to **three days per week**.

Employees are expected to work from their assigned office location on the remaining working days unless their manager approves a different arrangement.

New employees become eligible for remote work after completing their first **30 calendar days of employment**.

Remote work does not change an employee's expected working hours.

Employees must remain reachable during their team's agreed core collaboration hours.

The standard company-wide collaboration window is:

10:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST, Monday through Friday.

Managers may establish additional team-specific collaboration requirements when necessary for operational reasons.

3. Leave Policy

Full-time employees receive **24 days of paid leave per calendar year**.

The annual allocation consists of:

- **18 days of general paid leave**
- **6 days of personal leave**

Employees who join Northstar during the calendar year receive their annual leave allocation on a **prorated basis**.

Planned leave requests should normally be submitted at least **five working days before** the first day of leave.

Emergency leave may be requested with shorter notice when circumstances make advance notice impractical.

Employees should inform their manager as soon as reasonably possible when emergency leave is required.

4. Business Expense Reimbursement

Employees may request reimbursement for reasonable business expenses incurred while performing authorized company work.

Receipts are required for individual expenses **above INR 1,000**.

Expenses of INR 1,000 or less should still be recorded accurately in the company's expense portal.

Travel expenses must be submitted through the company's expense portal within **30 calendar days of the expense date**.

Approved reimbursements are normally processed within **10 business days after the expense report has been approved**.

Employees should contact the Finance team if an approved reimbursement has not been processed within the expected processing period.

5. Information Security

Employees must use **multi-factor authentication (MFA)** for company systems that support MFA.

Company credentials must not be shared with another person, including coworkers, contractors, friends, or family members.

Sensitive company documents must only be stored in company-approved storage systems.

Employees must not upload confidential company documents to personal cloud-storage accounts.

Employees should avoid accessing sensitive company systems from unsecured public computers.

If an employee suspects that their credentials have been compromised, they must report the incident to the security team as soon as possible.

The employee should also change the affected password if the relevant system allows the password to be changed.

6. Password Requirements

Company passwords must contain at least **12 characters**.

Employees are encouraged to use a password manager approved by the company.

Passwords must not be reused across company systems and personal accounts.

Employees must not write company passwords on publicly visible notes or store them in unencrypted text files.

7. Performance Reviews

Northstar Analytics conducts formal performance reviews **twice each year**.

Formal review cycles are generally scheduled in:

- **June**
- **December**

Managers are responsible for preparing written feedback before the review discussion.

Performance discussions may include project contributions, collaboration, technical development, communication, and progress against previously agreed goals.

8. Employee Development

Employees may request access to professional development resources related to their role.

Examples include:

- Technical courses
- Professional certifications
- Conferences
- Workshops
- Books and learning materials

Professional development requests should be discussed with the employee's manager before expenses are incurred.

Approval depends on the relevance of the requested resource to the employee's role and the department's available budget.

9. Travel Policy

Employees traveling for authorized business purposes may claim reasonable transportation, accommodation, and meal expenses in accordance with company guidelines.

Travel should normally be approved by the employee's manager before the trip is booked.

Employees should select reasonably priced transportation and accommodation appropriate for the business purpose of the trip.

Travel expense claims must be submitted within **30 calendar days after the expense date**.

Receipts must be retained for expenses where documentation is required by the Finance team.

10. Data Handling

Company information is categorized according to its sensitivity.

Employees should only access information necessary for their responsibilities.

Confidential information must not be shared externally without appropriate authorization.

When sending confidential information electronically, employees should use company-approved communication and file-sharing systems.

Documents containing sensitive information should not be left unattended in shared physical spaces.

11. Security Incident Reporting

A security incident may include:

- Suspected credential theft
- Unauthorized access
- Loss of a company device
- Accidental disclosure of confidential information
- Suspicious emails or phishing attempts
- Malware infections
- Unauthorized sharing of company data

Employees who identify a potential security incident should report it to the security team as soon as possible.

Employees should preserve relevant evidence where possible and should not attempt to conceal or delete information related to a suspected security incident.

12. Remote Work Equipment

Employees approved for remote work may receive company-provided equipment appropriate for their role.

Company laptops remain the property of Northstar Analytics.

Employees are responsible for taking reasonable precautions to protect company equipment from theft, damage, or unauthorized access.

Lost or stolen company equipment must be reported to the IT team as soon as possible.

13. Office Attendance

Employees who are required to work from an office should follow the working schedule established by their team.

Office attendance requirements may vary between teams depending on operational requirements.

Managers should communicate team-specific attendance expectations clearly to employees.

14. Document Retention

Employees should retain business documents according to the company's applicable retention requirements.

Documents should not be permanently deleted when they are subject to an active investigation, legal requirement, audit, or other authorized preservation request.

Questions about document retention should be directed to the appropriate Operations or Legal contact.

15. Policy Exceptions

Employees who need an exception to a policy should discuss the request with their manager.

Some exceptions may require approval from People & Operations, Finance, IT, Security, or another responsible department.

Approval of one exception does not automatically create a general exception for other employees.